

On the Value of a Slow Dictionary

Reading in a foreign language is an exercise in patience. The eye moves quickly, the mind lags behind, and an unfamiliar word can halt the whole sentence. A dictionary that interrupts this rhythm costs more than it gives.

The best tools of this kind are almost invisible. They wait at the edge of your attention, offer a definition when curiosity appears, and then disappear. Nothing is copied, nothing is saved, and nothing is uploaded; the reader simply keeps reading.

Consider the word deliberate. Seen once, it is a small puzzle; seen three times, in three different sentences, it becomes part of your vocabulary. That slow accumulation is the whole point of practice.